

September

29



Seeing the Pacific

1513

While hunting for gold in South America, Spanish explorer Vasco Núñez de Balboa crossed a strip of land called the Isthmus of Panama on foot and became the first European to see the Pacific Ocean. He claimed it for Spain, calling it the South Sea.

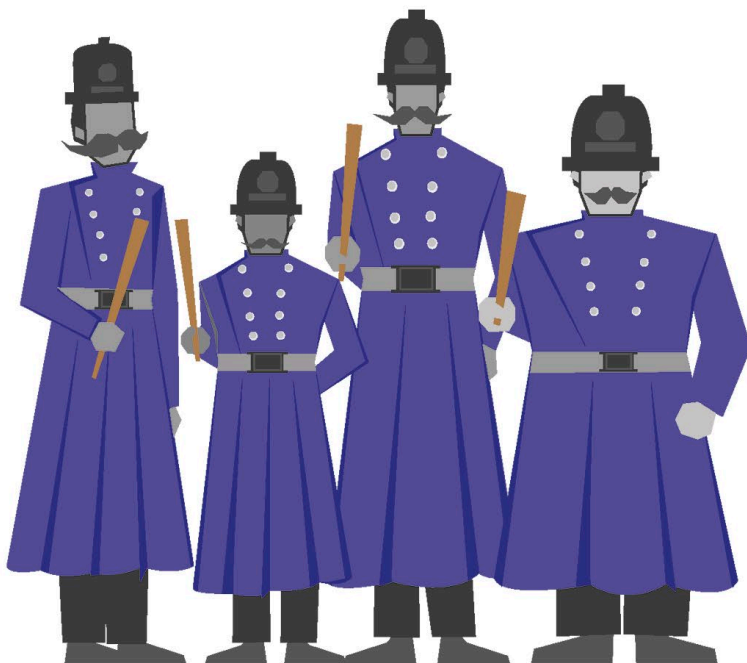
Born this day

1758 Horatio Nelson, British Navy commander. He led his ships to victory in a number of battles, most notably in the Battle of Trafalgar against France and Spain.

Bobby's peelers

1829

Dressed in blue suits and top hats, the first police officers in the world took to the streets of London, UK, after British politician Robert Peel launched his crime-fighting team – the Metropolitan Police Force.



Also on this day

1916 US oil tycoon John D Rockefeller became the first-ever US dollar billionaire.

2004 Asteroid 4179 Toutatis passed by Earth at a distance of about 1.5 million km (961,000 miles) – just four times the distance between Earth and the Moon.

2020 Scientists discovered three underground lakes on Mars using radar on the orbiting *Mars Express* spacecraft. They think these lakes must be very salty, as salt prevents water from freezing at low temperatures.